

3.1 The First Browser – WorldWideWeb (Nexus)



The WorldWideWeb (Nexus) Browser

Tim Berners-Lee invented the World Wide Web or WWW as we know it today in 1989, deploying a working system by 1990. Berners-Lee was the first to invent the browser, and it was simply called WorldWideWeb since it was the only way to see the Web. Tim later rechristened this browser 'Nexus', to distinguish between the program and the abstract information space "www" which was typed in the Uniform Resource Locator (URL). WorldWideWeb was written in Objective-C and it would let users browse "http:", "news:", "ftp:" and local "file:" spaces.

Tim wrote the program for this browser on a NeXT computer. The browser was the best at the time, since it was the only one. If you look at the browser closely, you will see that buttons and features in the browser look similar in Internet Explorer. Here's a brief low-down on the functionality of the browser.